Narayanan was a man of tremendous energy—a man always in the boost phase. He gathered around him a strong group of enthusiastic people, drawing many service officers into this predominantly civilian laboratory. Total y preoccupied with the SLV affairs, my participation in the Missile Panel meetings gradual y dwindled, and then stopped altogether. However, stories about Narayanan and his Devil were beginning to reach Trivandrum. A transformation of an unprecedented scale was taking place there.

During my association with Narayanan in the RATO project, I had discovered that he was a hard taskmaster—one who went al out for control, mastery and domination. I used to wonder if managers like him, who aim at getting results no matter what the price, would face a rebel ion of silence and non-cooperation in the long run.

New Year’s day, 1975, brought with it an opportunity to have a firstperson assessment of the work going on under Narayanan’s leadership. Prof. MGK Menon, who was working then as Scientific Advisor to the Defence Minister and was head of the DRDO, appointed a review committee under the chairmanship of Dr Brahm Prakash to evaluate